

Bioc Technical Advisory Board Minutes

3 September 2026

Present: Kasper D Hansen, Helena Crowell, Vincent Carey, Andres Wokaty, Gabriele Sales, Levi Waldron, Robert Castelo, Alexandru Mahmoud, Hervé Pagès, Ludwig Geistlinger, Rafael Irizarry, Jacques Serizay, Michael Lawrence

Absent: L. Gatto, L. Kern, W. Huber, H. Gruson

:03 - :04 August [minutes](#) approved.

:05 Please complete the [developer survey](#).

:06 Spotlight talk skipped for this meeting.

:06 - :10 **CAB/TAB election** (nomination form closed 31 August)

- 2 expiring terms, 2 new applicants (8-15 seats per [governance](#))
> Secretary will sent applications and voting form
- 2 of 3 executives need (re)election
> DECISION: current executive board maintained

:10 - :40 **TAB** size/composition, nomination/election, purpose

- Proposal: The Bioconductor Technical Advisory Board shall consist of 7 to 11 active members, with a target membership of 9, serving staggered three-year terms. Members are selected based on sustained contributions to Bioconductor, sound technical judgment, constructive engagement with Bioconductor, and willingness to participate in technical governance. Any current Board member may nominate a candidate by providing a brief description of the candidate's contributions and the expertise or perspective they would bring. The nomination must be circulated to all Board members and remain open for discussion for at least seven days. Appointment requires approval from at least two-thirds of the non-conflicted members voting and a majority of the full active Board. Members with a conflict of interest must abstain, and the candidate must agree to serve before the appointment is announced. Members may serve additional terms, but reappointment is not automatic: they must be renominated and approved through the same process before each new term.
- What problem is this change addressing? > Revision objectives: protect from random membership, allow addition of members with expertise in real time
- NO VOTE; to be thought about/discussed further

- Concept of an “**Executive director**”:
translate board concepts into action
- Tenure on the board is often short > Why?
- Individual initiative is an important factor in actual production
- Meeting objectives: **information vs. action**
 - Community manager exists
 - Developer liaison via Aedin's/Maria's grants
 - Group size: participants stay quiet if group is too large
 - Debate fundamental requirements, cadence, degree of compatibility/coherence

:40 - :47 **R25** implications for future conferences

- Target: developer-focused meeting
- Substantial funding (e.g., venue, travel support)
- Focus on recruiting in-person participants (PI+students/postdocs)
- No two conference; will be part of BioC2027
- Two Bioc sessions as part of STATGEN
- ENAR/JSM contributed sessions?

:47 - :51 Review of **BioC2026**

- AI meeting in Boston
- Full meeting in Seattle
- [BiocJobs](#) from hackathon: Way for package developers to dispatch scripts via workflows w/o knowledge of TES, CWL, etc.; simple definition via YAML
> translation to CWL (e.g., Nextflow, Galaxy)

:51 - :59 Package review & AI-generated code/packages

- 99 packages currently [in review](#)
- AI-generated package content can be problematic
- Concept of “**Associate editor**” roles in thinking about inviting or accelerating review of new software, especially in the face of agentically-authored submissions
- We have a commitment to uniform training about review from a technical perspective (what the package can and cannot do from a software engineering perspective) but limited support for substantive expertise contributing to package review
- Need AI usage guidelines; currently very limited (see [here](#))
- A working AI code reviewer system: [BiocReviews](#)
- Code review might be better done by AI at this point
 - > Bot review for security issues, adherence to package guidelines, etc.
 - > Reviewers focus on science, duplication, etc.

- It is questionable whether AI-generated packages are human-consumable (e.g., extremely verbose documentation)
> Should we assume they'll be used by agents?
- Simple ways to disclose AI usage should be put in place (e.g., prompt in package submission issue)
- Should we track "reputation" across labs/institutions? (e.g., consistently "bad" AI-usage/-slop)
- Issue of scalability (review, BBS)
> How many packages can we review/build routinely?

:59 - 60 **New infrastructure** for website, build/check, package distribution

- Team has made significant progress on transition from Git to GitHub
- Sean Davis has created a [system](#) that is running in parallel to the existing system that moves static website content to cloud buckets and handles dynamic aspects of services with more modern techniques